Nationality: American
Marital: Single
Dependants: None

Ken Austria

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Currently Based: Beijing, China

Profile

U.S. Teaching License: Computer Science (Grades 7–12) and English as a Second Language (Grades PreK–12). U.S.-educated (PreK–12 & B.A.) and native English speaker.

Results-driven Computer Science educator with 5+ years of international teaching experience and a background in Software Engineering and Psychology, offering proven expertise delivering AP, OSSD, and Cambridge IGCSE curricula. Experienced in designing rigorous, standards-aligned coursework, developing reusable instructional resources, and using assessment data to identify learning gaps and guide targeted interventions. Experience in curriculum design, school-wide program coordination, and educational technology integration.

Philosophy

I believe effective teaching balances rigor with accessibility, using data-informed instruction, scaffolded learning, and real-world applications. I prioritize student agency, critical thinking, and inclusive classrooms that support diverse learners in achieving measurable growth.

Qualifications

- **U.S. Standard Teaching License –** State ID: DC8477693810 **Expires March 2030**
    - Subject: Computer Science (Grades 7–12); English as a Second Language (ESL, PreK–12)
- **Bachelor of Arts: Psychology,** California State University: Sacramento, United States **May 2010**

Certifications & Professional Development

- **120 - Hour Teaching English as a Foreign Language,** United Kingdom **July 2021**
- **Full Stack Software Engineering Immersive,** App Academy **February 2019**
- **Front End Development,** Codecademy **January 2017**

Experience

Computer Science Teacher · Shuren Ribet Private School · Beijing, China **August 2026 – Present**

- Grade 9–10 Computer Science: Taught Information and Computer Technology using CBSE's Information and Computer Technology Class IX and X textbooks.
- Grade 11 Computer Science: Instructed Python programming using Python for Everybody as the course textbook.
- AP Computer Science Principles: Delivered AP-level Computer Science instruction, supporting students' development of programming skills and computational thinking.
- AP Psychology: Guided instruction to students through key concepts and their application to human behavior.
- Mathematics: Instructed high-rigor secondary mathematics courses, including Cambridge IGCSE International Mathematics (Grade 9) and OSSD Data Management (Grade 12), employing analytical problem-solving frameworks.

Computer Science Teacher · Pegasus California School· Qingdao, China **August 2024 – August 2026**

- Co-Curricular Program Coordinator: Coordinated the school-wide mandatory clubs program by managing faculty assignments, resource allocation, and curriculum standardization, while collaborating with senior leadership to ensure alignment with institutional goals and delivering consistent, high-quality student experiences that promote leadership, collaboration, and skill development.
- AP Computer Science A and Principles: Designed AP-aligned Computer Science curriculum resources, including reusable starter code, assessment rubrics, and spiral-review activities to support exam preparation.
- AP Psychology: Directed instruction in research methods and experimental design, emphasizing evidence-based reasoning and data-driven interpretation.

- English Literature (Grade 11): Managed a college-preparatory curriculum focused on American literature and high-level argumentative writing.

English Teacher · Beijing Haidian Foreign Language Tengfei School · Beijing, China **August 2023 – August 2024**

- Taught Grade 1 English aligned with Common Core State Standards, using dictation exercises and interactive phonics activities to develop letter-sound recognition and early literacy skills.
- Developed and delivered lessons on consonant-vowel-consonant (CVC) words and sight words to support phonemic awareness, decoding, and early English reading.

English Teacher · Sahmyook Education · Seoul, South Korea **November 2021 – August 2023**

- Seoul English Village Suyu Camp - Taught English to Grades 7–12 through immersive, conversation-based activities in themed classroom environments to develop students' speaking and communication skills.
- Seoul Sahmyook Elementary School - Supported elementary students' reading comprehension and vocabulary development through differentiated reading strategies and interactive, context-based learning activities.

Engineering Teacher · Hello World Studio · San Francisco, United States **May 2019 – May 2021**

- Applied CSTA K–12 Computer Science Standards to Grades 4–6 instruction, using assessment data to identify learning gaps and guide targeted instructional interventions.
- Mentored students through regular code reviews and assessment analysis, providing individualized feedback to address programming difficulties and guide skill development.

Front End Engineer · Associate Development Group Inc · New York, United States **November 2020 – February 2021**

- Streamlined legacy websites by reducing codebase by 25% through the implementation of reusable components.
- Optimized project completion rates by 10% through consistent progress updates and efficient communication.
- Transformed mockups into responsive websites with an average turnaround time of just 2 weeks per project.

Front End Engineer · AlzCare Labs · San Francisco, United States **October 2017 – May 2019**

- Improved component rendering speed from 12.7 to 8.5 milliseconds by reducing wasted renders.
- Collaborated with designers on the Zeplin platform to create responsive components from style guides.

Full Stack Engineer · Cureus · San Francisco, United States **January 2017 – September 2017**

- Built and deployed a CRUD RESTful API using Ruby on Rails and JavaScript.
- Contributed to the research, product design, development, and testing of software and tools.

Expertise

- Programming & Web Development: Python, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Ruby on Rails
- Development Tools: Visual Studio Code, Git, GitHub
- Curriculum & Standards: AP Computer Science, CSTA K–12 Computer Science Standards, AP Psychology, Cambridge IGCSE Mathematics, OSSD Mathematics
- Instructional Practice: Curriculum Design, Assessment Design, Differentiation, Data-Informed Instruction

Extracurricular

- **Coding Coach Mentor,** Open Source Software Engineer **April 2020**